title: "Good Governance Policy" effectiveDate: "" reviewDate: "" version: "1.0"

Good Governance Policy

Policy Title: Good Governance

Effective Date: [Insert Date]

Review Date: [Insert Date – usually annually]

Version: 1.0

Applies to: All staff, managers, and contractors at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]

1. Policy Statement

At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we are committed to the principles of good governance to ensure the safe, effective, and person-centred delivery of care. We maintain a governance framework that supports high-quality care, regulatory compliance, financial integrity, and continuous improvement.

This policy outlines how we manage performance, risk, quality, and leadership to meet legal and regulatory obligations — and ensure the wellbeing of residents and staff.

2. Legal and Regulatory Framework

This policy supports compliance with:

- Regulation 17: Good Governance (Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014)
- CQC Fundamental Standards
- Care Act 2014
- Data Protection Act 2018 / UK GDPR
- Health and Safety at Work Act 1974

3. Purpose

This policy aims to:

- Ensure effective oversight of the care home's operations
- Promote accountability at all levels of the service
- Support effective record-keeping and decision-making
- Improve quality, safety, and resident satisfaction
- Reduce risk and ensure legal and regulatory compliance

4. Governance Principles

We adopt the following core principles of good governance:

- Accountability – clear roles, responsibilities, and decision-making processes
- Transparency – open communication and information sharing
- Integrity – ethical leadership and behaviour at all levels
- Quality Focus – continuous improvement and learning culture
- Compliance – adherence to all applicable laws and standards

5. Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager

- Holds ultimate responsibility for governance and regulatory compliance
- Ensures appropriate systems and processes are in place for monitoring quality and safety
- Oversees audits, incident reporting, and service improvements
- Submits required notifications and returns to the CQC

Senior Management / Team Leaders

- Monitor day-to-day quality of care and support staff performance
- Identify risks, escalate concerns, and ensure that action plans are implemented
- Conduct supervision and appraisals in line with policies

All Staff

- Are expected to follow policies and procedures
- Participate in training and supervision
- Report concerns, incidents, and near misses promptly

6. Governance Systems in Place

6.1 Quality Assurance

- Regular internal audits covering care plans, medicines, infection control, safeguarding, etc.
- Resident and family feedback surveys
- Complaints and compliments monitoring
- Continuous improvement plans

6.2 Risk Management

- Risk assessments for residents, environment, staff safety, and operations
- Risk register maintained and reviewed regularly
- Action taken to mitigate identified risks

6.3 Information Governance

- Secure and confidential handling of resident and staff information
- Compliance with the Data Protection Act 2018 and UK GDPR
- Access to records is restricted to authorised staff only

6.4 Record Keeping

- Accurate, up-to-date, and accessible records maintained for care, staff, training, incidents, and governance activities
- Records retained and disposed of in accordance with policy

6.5 Incident and Complaint Management

- All incidents and complaints are logged, investigated, and analysed for trends
- Learning is shared and used to drive improvements
- Serious incidents are reported to relevant external bodies (CQC, safeguarding, RIDDOR, etc.)

7. Training and Supervision

- All staff complete mandatory training relevant to their role
- Supervision and appraisals are conducted regularly to monitor performance
- Staff are supported to reflect, develop, and uphold good governance principles

8. Monitoring and Review

- Governance performance is reviewed monthly by the management team
- Trends, audit results, and improvement actions are discussed in governance meetings
- This policy will be reviewed annually or following changes in legislation or best practice guidance

9. Related Policies

- Quality Assurance Policy
- Risk Management Policy
- Incident Reporting Policy
- Complaints Policy
- Record Keeping Policy
- Supervision and Appraisal Policy
- Data Protection and Confidentiality Policy

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